



Delaware County Council Meeting August 22nd 2023

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=VR2OnrKgXMY
Publication Date	2023-08-23T03:16:16Z
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Delaware County Council Meeting Report

Meeting Date: August 22, 2023

Body: Delaware County Council

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting was called to order by the presiding officer at 00:00:16. Public questions were directed to `CountyCouncilDco.delaware.in.us`.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Mr. Flanken, Mr. Hughes, Mr. K., Mr. M., Mr. Webb, Mr. Wad, Mr. Piper (Presiding Officer), Mr. Freeman.
 - **Members Absent:** None noted.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Mr. Piper.

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Opening led by Jane with the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Approval of Agenda:** Approved by roll call vote (all ayes).
- **Approval of Minutes:** Approval of the July 2023 council meeting minutes passed by roll call vote (all ayes).

3. Substantive Business & Board Action

A. Jail (Dept 145) Transfers

- **00:02:05 Item:** County General - Jail Line Transfers
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jail Administration / Finance Committee
- **Deliberation Summary:** Detailed review of numerous line-item transfers to address staffing shortages, correctional officer pay adjustments, and overtime. Officials noted that holiday overtime lines are utilized for general overtime and time-and-a-half rate adjustments due to ongoing vacancies and forced overtime.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.

B. Prosecutor (Dept 137) Transfers

- **00:07:19 Item:** Prosecutor Office Line Transfers
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Lisa Carr, Prosecutor's Office
- **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer to support a certified legal intern awaiting bar exam results who has volunteered for three years and will be hired as a deputy prosecutor upon passing.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.

C. Public Defender (Dept 139) Transfers

- **00:09:03 Item:** Public Defender Line Transfers
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Public Defender Office
- **Deliberation Summary:** Routine transfer balancing investigator fees and court-ordered attorneys.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.

D. Sheriff (Dept 129) Transfers

- **00:09:45 Item:** Sheriff Department Line Transfers
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Sheriff Tony Skinner
- **Deliberation Summary:** Transfers reflecting personnel movements, promotions, and increased overtime due to serious incidents and staffing dynamics. Discussion included the supplemental role of reserve deputies.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.

E. Treasurer (Dept 127) Transfers

- **00:14:33 Item:** Treasurer Line Transfers
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Treasurer's Office
- **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer from printing to computers.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.

F. Prosecutor Litigation Transfers

- **00:15:01 Item:** Prosecutor Litigation Line Transfers
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Prosecutor's Office
- **Deliberation Summary:** Minor administrative salary transfer for receptionist line.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.

G. Public Defender Storage Unit Transfer

- **00:15:43 Item:** Department 247 - Storage Unit Rent
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Shelley Harvey, Office Administrator
- **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer to cover increased storage unit rental fees (Storage Express on Granville) required by statutory document retention rules. Council members discussed the optics of paying external storage fees when county building space exists, noting future commissioner coordination.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Mr. Webb voted No).

H. Addendum 1: Jail, DOC Grant, Drug Court, Jail Lit, and Highway Transfers

- **00:19:48 Item:** Various Departmental Addendum Transfers
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Respective Department Heads / Finance Committee
- **Deliberation Summary:** Backfilling of correctional officers, DOC grant administrative adjustments (lowering mail/admin assistant line amounts), drug court financial manager adjustments, jail litigation adjustments, and highway truck driver line adjustments.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.

I. Addendum 2: 911 Communications & High Tech Crimes Unit

- **00:24:11 Item:** 911 Communications & High Tech Crimes Line Transfers
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Director Cummings / IT
- **Deliberation Summary:** Communications tech backfilling and training line adjustments (clarified as paying the training officer to train new personnel); High Tech Crimes unit supply and schooling adjustments.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.

J. Financials: Commissioners Institutional Care Appropriation

- **00:26:01 Item:** Department 153, Line 386 - Institutional Care
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jane Miranda, Community Corrections
- **Deliberation Summary:** Request for \$250,000 primarily supporting the jail release program (GCC GPS monitoring at \$14/day versus jail housing at \$37.50/day). Officials

highlighted that the program has saved the county \$2.6 million over five years despite rising medical and monitoring needs.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.

K. Financials: Data Processing Check Sealer Folder

- **00:38:41 Item:** IT Department 20 - Check Sealer Folder Equipment
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jim Fluker, IT Department
- **Deliberation Summary:** Request for \$6,500 to replace/maintain a 21-year-old check folding and sealing machine used primarily for accounts payable checks (~7,200 checks annually).
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.

L. Financials: Auditor Contractual Services

- **00:41:45 Item:** Department 126, Line 310 - Contractual Services
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Auditor's Office / Mr. Carol
- **Deliberation Summary:** Request for \$50,000 to pay for state-mandated third-party audits (including GAAP reports required for bond ratings and interest rates). Discussed as a non-funded state mandate billed on hourly contractor rates.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.

M. Financials: Bridge Community Crossing Grant

- **00:46:30 Item:** Fund 935 - Bridge Community Crossing Grant
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Carrie, Delaware County Highway
- **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriation of \$325,760.65 for replacing an old timber bridge on 650 East (just north of 350 North) with a modern concrete/rated bridge, utilizing state grant funding (\$651,000 total award).
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.

N. Financials: Fairgrounds Operating Supplies

- **00:48:20 Item:** Fund 4911 - Fairgrounds Operating Supplies
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Fairgrounds Administration
- **Deliberation Summary:** Request for \$4,000 for operating supplies, motor gas, and restroom products to finish the year following pre-fair maintenance purchases.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.

O. Financials: JDAI Grant Appropriation

- **00:51:24 Item:** Fund 9109 - Juvenile Detention Alternatives Initiative (JDAI) Grant
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Emily Anderson, Court Administrator

- **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriation of \$55,000 across food, office supplies, travel/training, and professional services contracts for juvenile probation grant programming (disbursed monthly/quarterly by the state).
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.

P. Financials: 911 Statewide PSAP Equipment

- **00:53:24 Item:** Fund 1222, Line 443 - PSAP Equipment
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** 911 Director
- **Deliberation Summary:** Request for \$200,000 from the 911 fund (not County General) to acquire a platform and software for auto-dispatching, reducing emergency response times by 15 to 45 seconds.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.

Q. Ordinances & Resolutions: Sheriff Commissary Ordinance (First Reading)

- **00:57:53 Item:** Ordinance 2023-18: Sheriff Commissary Ordinance
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Sheriff Tony Skinner / Mr. Freeman
- **Deliberation Summary:** Presentation of a proposed ordinance establishing formal, transparent guidelines and reporting for the Sheriff's commissary fund, incorporating statutory permissions (items 1<U+2013>8) and additional mutually agreed-upon categories (items 10<U+2013>21 modeled after other Indiana counties). Emphasized that the Sheriff retains statutory sole discretion over the fund, which undergoes annual State Board of Accounts audits and biannual reporting to Council.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Introduced for a first reading and approved by roll call vote.

4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

(Note: No public members signed up or spoke during the general public comment period.)

5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - **Rules Update:** Discussion regarding updating council rules (sections 3.02 and 6.02) to change document submission deadlines from 48 hours prior to 9:00 AM on the preceding Friday, for formal adoption in September.
 - **Committee Report:** Security committee met regarding justice and rehabilitation center security plan updates.
 - **Health First Indiana Funding:** Jamie Bane (Health Department) reviewed the newly accepted Health First Indiana funding (\$1.3 million in 2024, \$2.6 million in 2025) and

local match requirements, emphasizing local autonomy and public health performance metrics.

- **Property Tax Cap & Max Levy Reports:** Auditor's estimated property tax cap impact report received (no recommendations for review motion approved); estimated 2023 Max Levy noted at approximately \$30.8 million.
- **Coroner Update:** Gavin Green reported transition to paperless SharePoint operations and case volume trends.
- **Upcoming Meetings:** Pre-budget meeting scheduled for Tuesday, August 29, 2023, at 3:00 PM. Budget hearings kick off Wednesday, September 6, 2023, at 8:30 AM. Next regular council meeting scheduled for Tuesday, September 26, 2023, at 9:00 AM.
- **Adjournment:** Official motion to adjourn approved by roll call vote.

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